

THE EQUITY EXPRESSION OF THE CRITICAL MINERALS THESIS

The Price With No Market

Trump and Xi meet in Washington this week, and the flow of Chinese rare-earth magnets sits near the top of the agenda. Ahead of the summit, Chinese suppliers stopped shipping to some American buyers even where licences existed. Outside China, a kilogram of terbium oxide is now indicated at roughly four times the Chinese domestic reference. That gap is the clearest evidence yet that the strategic argument about mineral dependence was correct. It is also, so far, remarkably hard to find in anybody's profit and loss account.

A reframe worth holding onto

The internal view, from 13D Research's 17 September issue, is that vertical integration has stopped being a supply-chain efficiency strategy and become a national-security one, with mineral access as “the keystone”. Its investment conclusion follows directly: “for downstream industries price will increasingly become insensitive to reliable supply. Governments simply must have these metals and will be willing to pay any price.” This is a view, not a forecast, and it is a claim about *buyers*. Whether it becomes revenue for *sellers* is a separate question the reframe does not answer.

Method. External figures — spot prices, company results, summit logistics, export-control dates — are drawn from public reporting, exchange filings and company releases, and each carries an as-of date in the text. Internal figures and framings come from the Heyokha research Wiki's Critical Minerals page (created 23 June 2026, last reviewed 18 September 2026, 9,565 words) and are attributed to the named research provider as views, not verified fact. Where the two disagree, the disagreement is stated rather than resolved. No figure appears here that could not be sourced.

Picture a bakery whose oven depends on one obscure ceramic igniter, made by a single workshop three towns over. The igniter costs four pounds; the oven earns four thousand pounds a day. The baker would, without hesitating, pay a hundred times the list price rather than go dark. So when the workshop starts rationing, a second workshop opens nearby and quotes four hundred pounds. Everyone in the trade now agrees that four hundred pounds is “the price”. But the new workshop sells eleven igniters a year. It cannot raise a bank loan against eleven sales. It cannot sign a ten-year supply contract, because every customer knows the four-hundred-pound quote evaporates the day the original workshop resumes shipping. The baker's willingness to pay is entirely real. The new workshop's revenue is not. Critical minerals in September 2026 are the second workshop.

THE STORY IN 60 SECONDS

4.6×

Indicative delivered non-China dysprosium oxide (~US\$1,100/kg) against the Chinese domestic benchmark of US\$239.12/kg. *SMM domestic reference, 3 September 2026; non-China indication disclosed by USA Rare Earth, mid-September 2026.*

A\$222m

Lynas Rare Earths' FY26 earnings, up roughly 27-fold on FY25, on revenue of A\$978m (+76%). The economics can work. *Lynas FY26 results, year to 30 June 2026, reported 26 August 2026.*

−44%

MP Materials at US\$55.80 against its 14 October record of US\$100.25 — while export controls tightened all year. *Price as at 4 September 2026; Q2 2026 GAAP net loss US\$20.3m.*

A chokepoint that finally closed, and a price that split in two

China's control of rare-earth separation has been documented for a decade, but until recently it was leverage held in reserve. Over the past eighteen months it has been used. In April 2025 Beijing placed dysprosium, terbium, samarium and yttrium under export licensing. In October 2025 it announced a second wave covering holmium, erbium, thulium, europium and ytterbium, together with the equipment and technology used to make magnets — then suspended that second wave for one year, to **10 November 2026**, as part of the trade truce. On 22 June 2026 the Ministry of Commerce added ten American entities to its export-control list, among them MP Materials and USA Rare Earth, denying them dual-use export permits outright. Through August and early September 2026, according to Reuters reporting on 4 September, some Chinese suppliers went further and simply declined to ship to American customers who already held licences, for fear of what Beijing might make of it.

That last step matters more than it looks. A licensing regime is a policy instrument: it can be negotiated, relaxed, traded away at a summit. Voluntary supplier caution is not a policy instrument at all. It is a chilling effect, and it does not have an off switch that anyone in Washington can reach. Chinese rare-earth supply leverage now operates through channels that the Chinese government would have to actively dismantle rather than merely stop using.

The price consequence is a market that has separated into two. Inside China, dysprosium oxide was benchmarked at US\$239.12 per kilogram and terbium oxide at US\$1,097.08 per kilogram on 3 September 2026. Outside China, USA Rare Earth has disclosed indicative values near US\$1,100 per kilogram for dysprosium and US\$4,000 per kilogram for terbium — roughly five and four times the Chinese references respectively. Same element, same specification, different continent. The internal Wiki records a related and stranger fact from mid-2026: Chinese domestic dysprosium prices touched seven-year *lows* in June 2026, at the same moment the ex-China price was tripling.

The Washington summit is the near-term test. US Treasury Secretary Bessent and Vice Premier He Lifeng opened preparatory talks on 20 September covering artificial intelligence, tariffs and critical minerals, with the November truce deadline the immediate deliverable. American officials have said publicly that Chinese compliance on rare earths has been disappointing and that licences for magnet-grade material have not been issued even after the moratorium. Whatever emerges, it will be a political document, and the two-tier price structure will either narrow on it or widen against it within days.

THE ESSENTIAL DISTINCTION

A price that is *quoted* and a price that is *cleared* are not the same thing. The ex-China heavy rare-earth quotes are real observations of what a desperate buyer would pay for a small parcel. They are not yet a market: no exchange, no forward curve, no depth, no volume against which a producer can borrow. The whole Western critical-minerals build-out is an attempt to convert the first kind of price into the second.

MECHANISM

Following one kilogram of dysprosium oxide



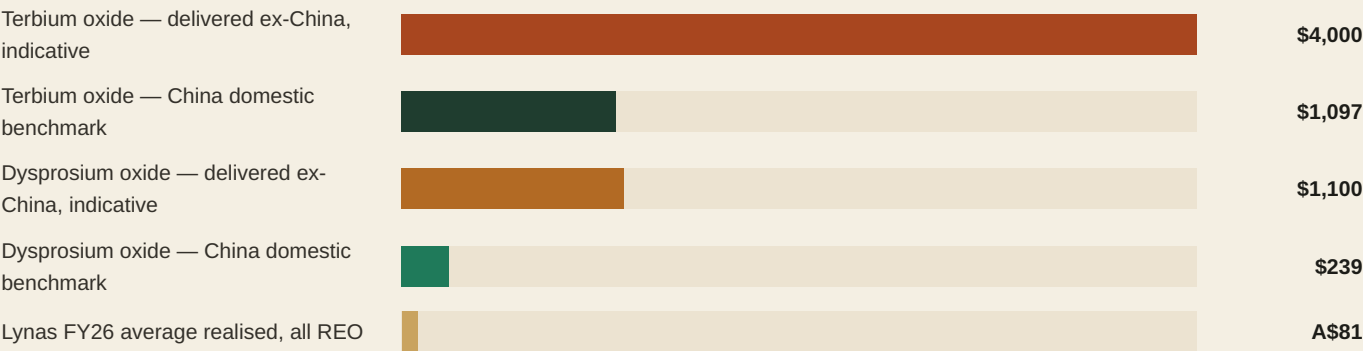
Separation-share figure: IEA Global Critical Minerals Outlook 2026 (16 July 2026) as summarised on the internal Wiki page — internal reading, not independently verified here. Export-control dates and price references: public reporting, dated in the text. Step 4 describes the general role of heavy rare-earth dopants in sintered NdFeB magnets; exact loadings vary by grade and are not stated here.



Panel one: public reporting on China's October 2025 announcement and its one-year suspension. Panel two: internal Wiki summary of the IEA Global Critical Minerals Outlook 2026, attributed to 13D Research's reading; the figure has not been checked against the IEA document itself. Panel three: internal Wiki record of 13D's 10 September 2026 webinar coverage; company guidance dates may change.

THE COMPARISON THE ARGUMENT TURNS ON

One element, two prices, and what a producer actually banked



Bars are illustrative and scaled to the highest value shown; they are not a like-for-like index. Chinese domestic benchmarks are SMM references as at 3 September 2026. Non-China indications were disclosed by USA Rare Earth in mid-September 2026 and reflect small parcels, not cleared exchange volume. The final bar is Lynas Rare Earths' FY26 average realised price across its entire rare-earth oxide basket — overwhelmingly light rare earths, principally neodymium-praseodymium — and is shown to make the mix point, not to imply Lynas sells terbium at that price. Currencies as marked and not converted.

A USEFUL MENTAL MODEL

Treat the ex-China heavy rare-earth quote less as a commodity price and more as an *insurance premium*. It is set by the perceived probability of a cut-off, not by the cost of digging. Premiums of this kind can stay elevated for years — and they can also collapse in a week on a single handshake, without one tonne of new supply ever entering the market.

THE STATE OF PLAY

What has actually shifted

WHAT HAS CHANGED	WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE IN THE DATA	WHY IT CUTS BOTH WAYS
Leverage moved from policy to behaviour	Suppliers declining licensed US orders from August 2026, on top of the June 2026 entity listings covering MP Materials and USA Rare Earth.	Harder to reverse at a summit, which supports the structural case. But it also means the tightness is not a decision anyone announced, so nobody can reliably price how long it lasts.
The price split became measurable	Dysprosium US\$239/kg inside China against ~US\$1,100 outside; terbium US\$1,097 against ~US\$4,000 (3 and ~17 September 2026).	It proves the chokepoint is binding. It also proves the ex-China price is set by scarcity of permission, not scarcity of rock — so new mines do not obviously capture it.
Governments became the marginal buyer	A conditional US\$400m Department of War loan to Sunrise Energy Metals; Lockheed Martin holding an option over roughly a quarter of early output; a US\$1.6bn US government letter of intent with USA Rare Earth.	State capital de-risks projects that private capital would not touch. It also makes the revenue line a political variable, subject to appropriations, administrations and midterms.
Earnings arrived — for the incumbent	China Northern Rare Earth's H1 2026 net profit of RMB 2.05bn, up 120%, on revenue of RMB 25.8bn, up 37%. Lynas FY26 earnings of A\$222m, up roughly 27-fold.	Two genuine profit inflections. But the largest belongs to the entity the West is trying to displace, and Lynas shares fell on the day of the quarterly regardless.
Western equities decoupled from Western earnings	MP Materials US\$55.80 on 4 September, 44% below its record and carrying a Q2 GAAP net loss of US\$20.3m, with US\$17.6m of that quarter's cash support coming from a price-protection agreement.	These shares now trade on policy headlines. That is upside on every announcement — and it means the market is not yet underwriting the operating business on its own terms.
A hard date entered the calendar	10 November 2026: the suspended second wave of controls reactivates by default, one week after the US midterms.	A forcing function that could validate every structural argument at once. Equally, a date at which a deal can be struck and the entire premium can deflate.

Bull and bear, stated fairly

The bull case

- **The buyer really is price-insensitive.** 13D's formulation — governments “will be willing to pay any price” — is grounded in the arithmetic of step four above: a few grams of dopant inside a component inside a weapons system. There is no cost discipline where the input is a rounding error and the output is a national capability.
- **The chokepoint is chemistry, and chemistry is slow.** The internal page puts China at 99% of heavy rare-earth refining and 94% of permanent-magnet output, with the IEA projecting China still at 72% of magnet production in 2035. Even a decade of Western effort leaves the dependence largely intact.
- **State capital changes the cost of the equity.** Conditional loans, offtake options and stockpiles are, in 13D's phrase, “durable support mechanisms”. A mine with a Lockheed option over a quarter of production and a Department of War loan is a fundamentally different risk object from a 2015 junior.
- **Profits have started to show up.** Lynas moved from marginal to A\$222m of earnings on a 60% rise in realised prices in a single year. This is no longer a thesis about 2035; one producer has already banked the inflection.
- **The sector is small enough to re-rate violently.** Robert Friedland's claim, recorded on the internal page, that the entire world mining industry is worth less than 1% of the S&P 500 is the mechanical reason modest reallocation produces outsized moves.
- **There is a scheduled catalyst.** 10 November arrives whether or not anyone is ready. Unresolved, it validates the thesis; the option is not being given away.

The bear case

- **The premium is a permission price, and permission can be granted.** An ex-China quote four times the domestic benchmark is not a cost curve. A workable communiqué in Washington this week could compress it faster than any new supply could, and nothing physical would have changed.
- **The flagship Western producer is losing money.** MP Materials posted a US\$20.3m GAAP net loss in Q2 2026 with US\$17.6m of quarterly support from a price-protection agreement, in the tightest export regime on record. If this environment does not produce operating profit, it is fair to ask what would.
- **The market will not pay for good results.** Lynas reported record production, record realised pricing and a 27-fold earnings increase, and the shares fell 5.95% on the quarterly. Investors appear to be discounting the durability of the price, not the delivery of the tonnes.
- **The incumbent's own accounts contradict the story told about it.** The internal view holds that China Northern Rare Earth's strategic value lies in “keeping prices low”. Its H1 2026 filing attributes a 120% profit increase to mainstream product prices *strengthening*. Both cannot be straightforwardly true.
- **Supply arrives after the deadline.** Sunrise targets first production in 2H 2028. The tungsten arithmetic on the internal page has eleven ex-China projects adding roughly 20,000 tonnes by 2030 against a still-projected 16,000-tonne gap. Investors are being asked to hold a two-to-four-year execution window across a political cycle.
- **Prices are being made by policy, not demand.** Rare-earth equities in 2026 have traded on trade and industrial-policy headlines rather than earnings. That is a description of a momentum market, and it works in reverse.

Two notes on how that bear case was built, because it matters. The internal Wiki page devotes roughly 9,500 words to this theme and its “Contradictions” section reads, in full, “*None yet.*” Its four bear-case headings — faster DLE scaling, battery-chemistry substitution, recession destroying EV demand, new discoveries — are each a single unelaborated sentence. So the bear case above was assembled from outside the Wiki: from external reporting, and from tensions sitting inside the companies' own published results. That is a legitimate way to build it, but readers should know it was not lifted from the internal file, because the internal file does not contain it.

WHERE THE VIEWS COME APART

Internal and external, unresolved

The sharpest divergence concerns China Northern Rare Earth. 13D's 17 September issue argues that the company's strategic value lies precisely in *not* maximising price — “capturing of global market share by keeping prices low, and in doing so securing global influence and allocation-power”. It is an elegant argument about how a state-directed champion differs from a profit-maximising one. The company's own half-year report, however, attributes a 120% increase in net profit to RMB 2.05bn to mainstream rare-earth product prices strengthening and to steady volume growth across smelting, separation, metals and magnetic materials. A firm suppressing prices to buy influence does not usually report that stronger prices doubled its earnings. Either the internal framing describes a longer arc than one half-year —

plausible, and 13D would likely say so — or the price suppression is less deliberate than the thesis requires. This edition does not resolve it. It is flagged because the entire “price insensitivity” conclusion rests on one side of it.

A smaller divergence worth recording: the internal page states that CNREG controls “approximately 70%” of China's authorised rare-earth mining quota in its September 2026 entry, while the same page's own summary field says 60%. Similarly, the August 2026 entries describe the US government's mining commitment as both “\$3 billion” (13 August) and a “\$2bn triage” (27 August). Neither gap changes the argument, but both are reminders that the internal file is a working synthesis rather than a checked record.

DASHBOARD

What to watch from here

SIGNAL	PLAIN-ENGLISH READING	WHY IT MATTERS
The Washington communiqué	Whether magnet licences are named specifically, or the text stays at the level of “cooperation on critical minerals”.	Named, dated licence commitments would start compressing the ex-China premium immediately. Vague language leaves the two-tier structure intact into November.
10 November 2026	Extension of the suspension, a new truce, or default reactivation of the second-wave controls.	The single largest scheduled repricing event for the theme. Falls one week after the US midterms, which shapes the political incentive on the American side.
The ex-China spread on dysprosium and terbium	Whether the roughly four-to-five-fold gap widens, holds or narrows over the next six weeks.	It is the cleanest live measure of whether the chokepoint is binding. A narrowing spread undercuts the investment case faster than any earnings miss.
MP Materials' operating result excluding price protection	Whether the underlying business turns cash-generative without contractual support.	Distinguishes a genuine industrial recovery from a subsidised one. This is the number that tells you whether the Western build-out is a business yet.
Terms of the Western reference price	What floor, if any, the Department of War actually negotiates into the Sunrise loan and comparable facilities.	13D treats the reference-price mechanism as the incentive that will call forth Western supply. Published terms would move it from concept to contract — or reveal that it is still a concept.
Chinese domestic heavy rare-earth prices	Whether domestic dysprosium stays near multi-year lows while ex-China prices hold up.	A persistent internal-external divergence is evidence of deliberate two-tier management. Convergence would suggest the squeeze is a genuine shortage rather than an allocation choice.

EXPRESSION

Three postures, not one answer

Own the chokepoint itself The incumbent Chinese processors are the only participants currently converting the situation into reported profit at scale, and they hold the quota. The explicit cost: this is a direct bet against the policy direction of every Western government, in securities subject to sanction risk, quota reallocation and a state shareholder whose objectives are not earnings per share.	Own the Western substitute The listed non-Chinese producers and developers are the leveraged expression, and the only one that benefits directly if the reference-price mechanism becomes real. The explicit cost: paying today for a price that is quoted but not yet contracted, in businesses whose supply largely arrives after the political window that created the opportunity has closed.	Own the buyer's adaptation Downstream users who can pass the cost through, recyclers, and the magnet and motor designers working to reduce heavy rare-earth loadings all gain from scarcity without needing the premium to persist. The explicit cost: the mineral is a small share of their cost base, so the earnings torque is correspondingly small. This is the posture that is right most often and pays least.
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The companies named on the following page are illustrative of how the theme is expressed in listed markets. They are NOT recommendations, and nothing here constitutes investment advice or a view on the suitability of any security for any investor.

MP

MP Materials Corp · NYSE

US\$55.80
as at 4 Sep 2026

The only integrated US rare-earth miner and magnet maker, operating Mountain Pass in California. Up about 10.5% in 2026 but 44% below its 14 October record of US\$100.25, and above a 29 July low of US\$37.81. Q2 2026 brought a GAAP net loss of US\$20.3m alongside US\$17.6m of price-protection income. Added to China's export-control entity list on 22 June 2026.

WATCH NEXT

Whether magnetics segment volumes lift operating profit without the price-protection contribution.

LYC AU

Lynas Rare Earths · ASX

FY26 earnings A\$222m
reported 26 Aug 2026

The largest rare-earth separator outside China. FY26 oxide production rose 25% to 13,089 tonnes and NdPr 11% to 7,260 tonnes, with a record 3,853 tonnes of NdPr in the second half. Average realised price rose 60% to A\$80.7/kg, and the June quarter averaged A\$98/kg. Revenue reached A\$978m. Shares nonetheless fell 5.95% on the quarterly release.

WATCH NEXT

Heavy rare-earth separation ramp at Mount Weld and Malaysia — the only ex-China route to dysprosium and terbium at scale.

USAR

USA Rare Earth, Inc. · Nasdaq

~US\$18.60
September 2026

A magnet-first developer, which completed its combination with Serra Verde on 3 September 2026 and disclosed a letter of intent for access to US\$1.6bn of US government funding alongside a US\$1.5bn private raise. It is also the source of the indicative non-China dysprosium and terbium prices used throughout this edition — a position that is informative and interested at the same time.

WATCH NEXT

Conversion of the government letter of intent into drawn, conditioned facilities with disclosed terms.

SRL AU

Sunrise Energy Metals · ASX

A\$19.39
September 2026

The purest expression of the reference-price idea. A March 2026 feasibility study for Syerston outlined roughly US\$120m of capital cost, life-of-mine site cash costs near US\$534/kg of scandium oxide and about 60 tonnes a year over 32 years. Lockheed Martin holds a multi-year option over up to 15 tonnes, roughly a quarter of Phase 1. Up about 147% year to date. First production targeted 2H 2028.

WATCH NEXT

Whether the Department of War loan closes with a disclosed price floor, or without one.

600111 CH

China Northern Rare Earth · SSE

RMB 2.05bn, +120%
H1 2026

The forward-integrated incumbent — mining, separation, metallurgy, magnets and recycling — holding the dominant share of China's authorised mining quota. H1 2026 revenue rose 37% to RMB 25.8bn and total profit 94% to RMB 2.98bn, which the company attributes to strengthening mainstream product prices. It is simultaneously the subject of the internal thesis and the counter-evidence to part of it.

WATCH NEXT

Whether H2 margins expand further, or compress in a way consistent with deliberate price restraint.

4063 JP

Shin-Etsu Chemical · TSE

Vietnam capacity
2,200 t/yr magnets

The adaptation case. Shin-Etsu has run integrated rare-earth separation, refining and magnet production at Hai Phong in Vietnam since 2013, capacity since doubled to 2,200 tonnes a year. The internal Wiki records Japanese industry warnings — more than two-thirds of roughly 200 Tokyo filings mentioning rare earths in May–June 2026 flagged operational risk — and a reported move to build new domestic refining capacity.

WATCH NEXT

Whether Japanese buyers keep paying European spot for yttrium, or Chinese licences to Japan resume.

The bottom line

What was repriced over the past eighteen months was not the scarcity of rare earths. It was the value of *permission*. Dysprosium is not rare and the rock has not moved; what changed is that a licence is now required to move it across a border, and a fourfold price gap has opened between the two sides of that border. That is a genuine, measurable, dated fact, and it vindicates the structural argument the internal research has made for years. It is also a fact about administrative control rather than geology, which is why it has produced a spectacular index return and a loss-making flagship producer in the same period.

The evidence is mixed in a specific and instructive way. The buyers are behaving exactly as the thesis predicts — governments contracting directly with miners, defence primes taking offtake options, letters of intent worth billions. The sellers, on the whole, are not yet showing it: two producers have posted real profit inflections, one of them Chinese, and the most prominent Western name is still loss-making at the operating line. The reasonable inference is that the theme is correct about direction and unproven about capture, and that the window in which the two get reconciled is short. The next test is dated: whatever Washington produces this week, and then 10 November, when the suspended controls either lapse or bite.

Editorial note. This is educational commentary prepared for internal use. It is not investment advice, not a recommendation, and not an offer or solicitation in respect of any security. Companies are named to illustrate how a theme is expressed in listed markets; naming a company implies no view on its merits and no position. External figures are attributed and carry as-of dates; prices and company data move, and readers should assume anything quoted here is stale by the time it is read. Internal views drawn from the Heyokha research Wiki are the opinions of the named research providers, are labelled as views rather than forecasts, and have not been independently verified. Where internal and external evidence conflict, the conflict has been stated rather than resolved. No figure has been estimated, inferred or interpolated; figures that could not be sourced were omitted.

Sources and update notes

(a) Internal. Primary page: **Critical Minerals** (type: theme; status: active; created 23 June 2026; last reviewed 18 September 2026; 9,565 words). Provider issues relied on: **13D Research** WILTW 17 September 2026 (vertical integration as national-security strategy; CNREG and BYD as worked cases; “all bottlenecks are created equal”; the price-insensitivity conclusion; China first in 39 of 77 USGS mineral commodities; Xi’s Washington travel flagged one week ahead); **13D WATMTU** 13 September 2026 (Critical Minerals Index +2.5% on the week against the Uranium Index –6.9%; index +398.5% since the February 2025 launch as at 10 September, restated to +363.1% in the following issue); **13D WILTW** 10 September 2026 (Sunrise Energy Metals and the scandium webinar; the US\$400m Office of Strategic Capital conditional loan; the Western reference-price mechanism; the Lockheed Martin right of first offer; Friedland on mining below 1% of the S&P 500); **13D WILTW** 3 September 2026 (“a resounding no” on Western supply; US 100% net-import reliant for 13 critical minerals and above 50% for 34 more; substitution limits); **13D WILTW** 27 August and 13 August 2026 (the Department of State minerals summit, the US\$3bn commitment and the later “\$2bn triage” characterisation; the DIBC conference); **13D WILTW** 30 July 2026 (the EU–China 14-v-14 sanctions exchange and the 10 November 2026 deadline); **13D WILTW** 16 July 2026 (its reading of the IEA Global Critical Minerals Outlook 2026, including the US\$6.5tn at-risk figure, the 99% heavy rare-earth refining share and the ex-China price bifurcation); **CLSA Bits & Pieces** 11 September 2026 (tungsten arithmetic; the Currie scarcity and debasement framing); **White Box** 16 September 2026 (de Gregorio’s use of rare-earth refining share as a constraint on AI governance).

(b) Limitation on the internal view. This page is close to a single-provider document. Of the fifty-two sources listed in its front matter, approximately fifty are 13D Research issues; the remaining two are one White Box note and one CLSA deck, both added within the last fortnight. The performance record cited throughout — the 13D Critical Minerals Index at several hundred per cent since a February 2025 launch — is the provider’s own proprietary index, self-reported, with no disclosed constituent list, weighting method or independent calculation agent, and it has been restated across issues in ways the page itself records. The page’s “Contradictions” section is empty and its four bear-case headings are unelaborated single sentences, so the page contains no meaningful internal challenge to its own thesis. Two figures are internally inconsistent: CNREG’s quota share appears as both 60% and approximately 70%, and the US government mining commitment as both US\$3bn and US\$2bn. None of this makes the underlying argument wrong. It does mean the internal file should be read as one well-informed house view, consistently argued over four years, rather than as a balance of evidence.

(c) External sources. (1) Reuters via CNBC and US News, 20 September 2026 — Treasury Secretary Bessent and Vice Premier He Lifeng to hold preparatory talks on AI, trade and critical minerals ahead of the Trump–Xi Washington summit; the trade truce expires 10 November; US officials describe Chinese compliance on rare-earth magnet flows as insufficient and note licences not issued after the moratorium. (2) NPR, 17 September 2026 — summit logistics and agenda. (3) Reuters via US News, 4 September 2026 — Chinese rare-earth firms halting some licensed US shipments from August 2026 over fear of repercussions. (4) S&P Global Market Intelligence and Benchmark Mineral Intelligence, June 2026 — China added ten US entities including MP Materials and USA Rare Earth to its dual-use export-control list with effect from 22 June 2026. (5) Rare Earth Exchanges and Shanghai Metals Market references — dysprosium oxide US\$239.12/kg and terbium oxide US\$1,097.08/kg, Chinese domestic benchmarks as at 3 September 2026; USA Rare Earth indicative non-

China values near US\$1,100/kg dysprosium and US\$4,000/kg terbium, mid-September 2026. (6) Schaeffer's Investment Research, 4 September 2026 — MP Materials at US\$55.80, up 4% on the day and 10.5% in 2026, against a 14 October record of US\$100.25 and a 29 July 52-week low of US\$37.81; MP Materials Q2 2026 GAAP net loss US\$20.3m with US\$17.6m of price-protection agreement income. (7) Lynas Rare Earths FY26 results, reported 26 August 2026, via Investing.com and The Motley Fool Australia — revenue A\$977.95m (+75.7%), earnings A\$222.35m (+2,682.9%), REO production 13,089 tonnes (+25%), NdPr 7,260 tonnes (+11%), second-half NdPr 3,853 tonnes, average realised price A\$80.7/kg (+60% on A\$50.6), June-quarter average A\$98/kg, shares −5.95% to A\$15.01 on the release. (8) Shanghai Stock Exchange and SMM, August 2026 — China Northern Rare Earth H1 2026 revenue RMB 25.8bn (+36.75%), net profit attributable RMB 2.05bn (+120.46%), total profit RMB 2.98bn (+94.37%), EPS RMB 0.5679, attributed to strengthening mainstream product prices. (9) USA Rare Earth Form 8-K disclosures and Yahoo Finance, September 2026 — Serra Verde combination completed 3 September 2026; US government letter of intent for access to US\$1.6bn; US\$1.5bn private raise; share price approximately US\$18.60. (10) Yahoo Finance, Simply Wall St and IBTimes Australia, September 2026 — Sunrise Energy Metals at A\$19.39, up about 147% year to date; March 2026 Syerston feasibility study with roughly US\$120m capex, US\$534/kg life-of-mine site cash cost and about 60 tonnes a year over 32 years; Lockheed Martin multi-year option over up to 15 tonnes of scandium oxide. (11) Shin-Etsu Chemical company news releases — integrated rare-earth separation, refining and magnet manufacturing at Hai Phong, Vietnam, since 2013, capacity doubled to 2,200 tonnes a year. (12) Reuters via Mining.com and Fastmarkets, 2026 — tungsten APT at record levels; China limited 2026–27 tungsten exports to fifteen licensed firms from December 2025. (13) CNBC, 3 February 2026 — the US critical-minerals stockpile programme and the equity reaction to it.

(d) Editorial choices in this automated run. Critical Minerals was selected by the standing hot-first rule. Scoring entity mentions across the twenty-one days of source summaries to 21 September, weighted for recency and for appearance in a source title, it was the highest-scoring eligible theme at fifteen points, carried by the 17 September 13D WILTW, the 18 September CLSA deck, the 16 September White Box note and four earlier issues. Three higher-scoring entities were skipped on cooldown: **AI Capex** (21 points; last run 8 September), **Gold** (20; 26 August) and **Oil & Gas** (16; run earlier this same morning, 21 September). The cooldown set was built by reading the archive folder directly and parsing all forty-four prior editions by filename, so the thirty-day check is complete rather than inferred; no bridge failure occurred. Two topic-selection judgements are worth recording: Copper scored nine and fell just outside the thirty-day window at thirty-three days, but has been the subject of four editions since 3 August and was passed over on repetition grounds; China Equities scored eleven at thirty-one days and was passed over on the same basis. The Wiki MCP server returned all requested sections without failure, though the theme catalogue exceeded the response limit and was extracted by pattern match rather than read whole. On external data, direct market-data fetching is unavailable in this environment, so all prices and results here come from dated public reporting rather than a live feed; where two reports gave conflicting units — notably for tungsten APT, quoted variously per tonne and per metric tonne unit — the figure was dropped rather than reconciled, and only the qualitative fact retained. The bear case was constructed externally, for the reason stated in the body.

Prepared 21 September 2026 · Heyokha Brothers Market Field Guide · Commentary, not investment advice.